SpeechGeek Presents



Female/Female Duos, Vol. 2

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SpeechGeek Presents: F/F Duos, Vol. 2

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Corey Alderdice
Editor and Publisher

806 Brownstone Way
Bowling Green, KY 42104
(270) 705-3632

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Here's the message I started off with in the intro to our first edition of female/female duos:

One of the questions I receive most often from forensics coaches and competitors is, "Where can I find a good female/female duo?"

It seems that was a more-than-accurate assertion.

In the few months since that issue of scripts was released, it has quickly become our fastest selling individual issue.

Based on your needs and enthusiastic response, we wasted no time in assembling five more female/female duos from a group of talented authors.

I hope you enjoy these scripts. If you have ideas for future types of scripts for **SpeechGeek Presents**, please send an email to thegeek@speechgeek.com!

Corey Alderdice
Publisher

SpeechGeek

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A Brief Primer...

by Julia Neva

BETH. (*to audience*) Well hi there, ho there happy faces. How is everyone doing this morning? (Silence) Anyone? (Silence) Can those of you in the back of the room hear me? (*awkward silence*)

SARAH. (*to audience*) Listen up, people! She asked you a question. The woman wants to know how you're doing!!

BETH. SARAH...

SARAH. Yes?

BETH. I'm gonna need you to pump the breaks on the ole enthusiasm wagon there, okay?

SARAH. Yes ma'am.

BETH. As I was saying...I hope everyone is doing okay this morning...

SARAH. (*in a loud whisper with great energy*) Doin' great!

BETH. ...and that no one had any trouble finding the room...

SARAH. (*same whisper*) None whatsoever!

BETH. ...and that everyone is ready to learn...

SARAH. (*same whisper*) Boo-yah!

BETH. (*gritting her teeth)* Sarah!

SARAH. Sorry.

BETH. Thank you! AS I WAS SAYING...(*looks at SARAH. Sarah 'zips' mouth shut)* My name is Dr. Elizabeth Lady - but you can call me Dr. Lady.

SARAH. But not 'Lady Doctor' because that would be super awkward...unless you had an appointment!! Get it? "Lady Doctor"? (*laughs at her own joke, Beth is not amused*)

BETH. You get three strikes.

SARAH. I'm sorry.

BETH. That was strike one.

SARAH. I'm sorry.

BETH. Two more outbursts and I'll be reassigning you to manure duty at the Humanities Department's annual "Rodeo for the Homeless" fundraiser. You wanna start shoveling horse biscuits full time or do you want to let me start my lecture?

SARAH. (*very quiet)* Lecture.

BETH. Okay. (*demeanor quickly changes when she speaks to audience)*

Okay! Welcome to WOMN 101: A Brief Primer on the Female Species. As an introduction to Women's Studies - we will be covering the impact women have had on the world.

SARAH. From the first woman to first ladies…

BETH. …from bra burning and baby raising…

SARAH. …to leg shaving and job hunting…

BETH. …from Helen of Troy and Joan of Arc…

SARAH. **…**to Lady Godiva and Lady Gaga.

BETH. We will be breaking down all the man-made myths and mister mistakes that have been perpetuated against womankind for centuries. With the help of my graduate assistant, Sarah…

SARAH. What up, fools.

BETH. We're going to re-write history.

SARAH. And turn it into her-story.

BETH. Or rather, our-story. With that…let's get started. And what better place to get started than:

SARAH. Chapter 1: Rave in the Cave

(*Both begin chanting Oooga-chakka. Oooga-chakka. Oooga-chakka. SARAH becomes the male cave-dweller while BETH plays the female cave-dweller)*

CAVE MAN. (*grunts)* Argh. Ungh. Me home.

CAVEWOMAN. (*working busily, not paying much attention*) Well it's about time. I could use a break.

CAVE MAN. No break.

CAVEWOMAN. Excuse me?

CAVE MAN. Me say you no break.

CAVEWOMAN. I heard what you said.

CAVE MAN. So what your big deal?

CAVEWOMAN. My 'big deal' is that I've been working all day to try and make this cave look respectable.

CAVE MAN. Argh. Ook. No care. Bring meat. (*heaves a giant bloody corpse onto the floor of the cave, right in front of BETH)*

CAVEWOMAN. No no no no!!! I just cleaned up the floor and you just got fur and blood all over the place.

CAVE MAN. Eat meat.

CAVEWOMAN. Did you not hear what I just said?!? I've spent the entire

day chasing rodents out of the cave, collecting berries, throwing the old bones out and trying to mend the torn loin cloths so we don't have to walk around with our…. (*whispers*) 'vulnerables showing'. I'm not an animal.

CAVE MAN. (*unaffected*) So what? You want cookie? Me no care. You woman. This you job. Me man. Me hunt.

CAVEWOMAN. (*frustrated)* ARGH!

CAVE MAN. (*howls back)* Orook! Oook!

CAVEWOMAN. (*shouts at him)* OH, GO EAT A ROCK YOU PRIMATE!! (*starts grumbling to herself*) Ugh. (*looks down*) Great. Look what the caveman drug in, a big pile of twigs and sticks. (*picks up sticks, pretends they're puppets, creates a mock dialogue rife with sarcasm)* 'Hello sweetheart how was your day?' "ACK! ACK! ACK!" "Oh, I'm fine. You know, just tending the hearth. By myself. All day." " ACK! ACK!"

CAVE MAN. Me in cave. Me hear you. Me no scratch in peace when you speak.

CAVEWOMAN. "ACK! ACK!" "Here, DEAR, let me help you with that rotting, stinking corpse you just drug home!" (*begins to furiously rub sticks together while screaming furiously in frustration, as if the puppets were fighting*) Take that!! (*suddenly, the sticks burst into flames, she stares in shock)* What just happened?

CAVE MAN. What that?

CAVEWOMAN. I don't know. I've never seen this before. It's orange…(*touches it and winces)* Ow! It hurts. It's hot. Burning hot.

CAVE MAN. Give me that. (*holds fire next to where the meat is)* Bright makes meat smell good. (*tastes meat)* Bright makes meat taste good.

CAVEWOMAN. This is amazing! I was able to create enough friction by rubbing those two stick together that they combusted into a flame…this flame can cook meat, keep us warm and protect us from enemies. I've created…

CAVE MAN. Me make fire.

CAVEWOMAN. Wait…what?

CAVE MAN. Me make fire. Me change world.

CAVE WOMAN. But…but you didn't make fire. I did. I changed the world.

CAVE MAN. No matter. You woman. No people believe you.

CAVE WOMAN. (*Disheartened)* Oh. Well. (*exiting)* One day that's all going to change.

CAVE MAN. Orook. Ook. Good luck with that.

(*BETH and SARAH go back into lecture mode)*

BETH. But history would prove that women need much more than luck to get the respect they needed.

SARAH. Chapter 2: Human War Resources

(*transition into next scene)*

LOU. (*always in a thick, comical French accent)* Ah swear. Zees pay-pur work weel be zee death of me. Ah said to my mother, "Mama, I want to be a painter when I grow up." "No, no, no, no - mon petite croissant - you mahst join zee French ahrmy! You mahst reed our country of zee Eenglish swine!" Eencredible.

ASSISTANT. Monsieur Tennant? Monsieur Lou Tennant?

LOU. Oui?

ASSIST. There is a person here to see you.

LOU. Ees eet mah mother?

ASSIST. No sir. It's a person to speak to you about joining the military.

LOU. Breel-lee-ant! What is his name?

ASSIST. Arc.

LOU. Ah! Yes! Arc! I've heard so much about this Arc lad! Send heem een!

ASSIST. Um. Monsieur Lou Tennant, I think there is something you need to know about…

LOU. Ah know all ah need to know about Arc. Hee ees a mahster strahtegist. A breel-lee-ant wahr-rior. Now send heem een!

ASSIST. Okay, Monsieur Lou Tennant. (*grumbling as she exits)* Don't say I didn't warn you.

LOU. Pardon?

JOAN. (*enters enthusiastically)* Hello sir! My name is Joan and I am here to

be all that I can be in the French Army!

LOU. Leetle gurl. Ah need you to leave. Ah am waiteeng for zees Arc guy zat ah have heard all about.

JOAN. Oh wow.

LOU. What?

JOAN. This is really awkward.

LOU. Zees ees? Why?

JOAN. I'm Arc. I'm Joan…of Arc. Arc is the town where I'm from. Joan…of Arc.

LOU. (*laughs)* You are hee-lar-ee-us.

JOAN. I am?

LOU. Oui…oui…

JOAN. I don't get it.

LOU. Come on…

JOAN. What?

LOU. Don't make me say eet.

JOAN. Uh. Okay. Look, I've filled out the application to join the French Army. I've completed all of my physical training and I ranked higher than most of the other guys that applied.

LOU. (*still laughing*) Ees thees a joke? Ees eet? Come out you jokers! Francois, eef thees ees your ah-dee-yah, ah'm going to freek out!

JOAN. I'm being serious, sir.

LOU. So am ah. Ah weel see-ree-usly freek out! Francois?

JOAN. SIR!

LOU. Excuse moi. Ah'm French. Ah haven't laughed thees hard een ah while.

JOAN. I understand, but you have to listen to me. I can help the French army overthrow the English. I can get Charles VII to the throne. (*hushed)* I don't want to brag, but I'm coming in with extensive intelligence reports. I have references you wouldn't believe.

LOU. Oh reeally? Where do zee references and intelligence reports you have come from?

JOAN. (*looks around, then speaks in a low quiet tone)* God.

LOU. (*quiet for a moment, then bursts out in guffaws)* God?!? God is your professional reference?!?

JOAN. If you'll just listen to me, Monsieur Lou Tennant. I want to fight for France.

LOU. Hahaha. Ah can see eet now. (*in a shrill female voice)* "'allo monsieur soldier! Ah am here to keel you!" (*in a deep male voice)* "Oh and how do you plan on doing that? With a sword?" "No! Weeth God! Ah weel pray you to death!" Hahahaha! Oh, zat is good.

JOAN. I don't get it! I'm one of the best soldiers you'll ever find! I want to defend my country and I have divine intervention on my side. I don't understand why you've done nothing but laugh at me since I've walked in your door. Give me one good reason why I'm less qualified than anyone else in the French military.

LOU. You lack zee one…er…"piece of equipment" zee others have.

JOAN. You know what? I don't care if you want to hire me or not. I'm going to get the English out of here and maybe when I do - you'll think twice about denying someone an opportunity just because of their sex or gender. (*exits)*

LOU. Bon soir. Good luck weeth zat.

(*BETH and SARAH go back to lecture mode.)*

SARAH. Ugh. What a pig.

BETH. Indeed, Sarah.

SARAH. But I mean - go Joan! Right? She did what she said she would! She was a pivotal key in the Hundred Years War. She…

BETH. Was burned alive as a heretic. It wasn't until nearly 15 years later when Charles VII, the man she fought to make sure would take over France's throne, needed to do some retroactive PR. Seems that the king seemed less than royal when he came to power at the hands of a woman considered to be an insane criminal. It was then she was cleared as a martyr.

SARAH. Ouch. That's…kind of…not cool.

BETH. Pretty much.

SARAH. Okay! So which historical woman is next? Queen Elizabeth?

BETH. Nope.

SARAH. Marie Curie?

BETH. No.

SARAH. Uh…how about another dynamic student teacher duo: Helen Keller and Annie Sullivan?

BETH. Don't kiss up. You're close. While all of these ladies have made wonderful contributions to our her-story, there's another duo I'm interested in discussing: Lucy Burns and Alice Paul.

SARAH. I'm not sure I know who you're talking about.

BETH. Sadly, my dear, most people don't.

SARAH. Chapter 3: The Suffragettes

(*transition into next scene - both ALICE and LUCY are imprisoned)*

ALICE. (*angrily shouting)* Hey guard! Yeah…you! Can you hear me? Why don't you come in this jail cell, just you and me, and I'll show you what it means to hit like a girl!

LUCY. Alice, calm down. The last thing we need is for you to get killed.

ALICE. Don't worry, Lucy. (*to guard)* HE DOESN'T STAND A CHANCE!

LUCY. He is easily triple your size, dear.

ALICE. I don't care.

LUCY. Yes you do. (*crosses to her)* You know we can't do this without you. (*looks at her)* Your lip is bleeding. Was it the feeding tube?

ALICE. No. It was the guard. I bit him when he tried to force the tube down my throat. I broke the skin, so he broke my lip.

LUCY. Oh dear.

ALICE. I think he may have busted my jaw up in the process.

LUCY. (*fixing her lip)* What am I going to do with you?

ALICE. I'll tell you what you're going to do with me. You're going to keep fighting alongside me until we have our demands met.

LUCY. True. (*pained expression)* There. You're all fixed up.

ALICE. How long has it been since you've eaten?

LUCY. (*worn out)* On my own? I'm not sure. I've lost track of time in here. Now, with the tube…

ALICE. See, you keep talking about me being a fighter. I heard the ladies talking. They said it took five guards to pin you down. They couldn't even pry your mouth open. That's strength.

LUCY. That's torture, Alice. Let's not forget that. Or any of the other indignities they've dealt us.

ALICE. I know, Lucy.

LUCY. What we're doing is going to rewrite history. It's going to give women everywhere a vote. Giving women the right to vote is giving

them a chance to make their voices heard. (*both pause, cringe at the sound of a woman screaming)*

ALICE. Who is that?

LUCY. I can't tell. It's hard to tell screams apart.

ALICE. (*off-stage to woman screaming)* We're here for you, sister!

LUCY. (*off-stage to woman screaming)* Stay strong! This is for our daughters and grand-daughters! (*BOTH react quickly to a guard at their cell door)*

ALICE. Back off, guard. What? Is there a law against shouting now?

LUCY. We were simply voicing support for a fellow comrade, sir. No harm done.

ALICE. Why don't you go back to your desk - you filthy pig. (*spits at officer, he grabs her by her throat, she struggles)*

LUCY. *(runs to ALICE, tries to pry guard from her neck)* Let her go! LET HER GO! She can't breathe! If you kill her you'll have first-degree murder on your hands. Then you'll be trapped in here with the rest of us! Do you want that? LET GO OF HER! (*ALICE is dropped to the ground, gasping, LUCY kneels to her side)* Your mercy is staggering.

ALICE. Thanks, Lucy.

LUCY. I still don't understand how the rest of the world thinks we're the lunatics. We're simply asking for the same rights as men. Tell me what's so crazy about that.

ALICE. Beats me. By the way, being 'trapped' in here with you isn't all that bad.

LUCY. Thank you dear. Make sure that when we get out, you write that down.

ALICE. I will, Lucy. I will.

(*BETH and SARAH transition back into lecture mode)*

BETH. Those two women would play a key role in assuring women the right to vote. Sarah, what does the textbook say?

SARAH. (*reading)* Alice Paul drafted the first proposal of the Equal Rights Amendment to the U.S. Constitution in 1923. The ERA was intended to guarantee that equal protection to any local, state or federal law could not be denied on the basis of gender. It took nearly 50 years

for the amendment to receive congressional approval. It has been introduced in every congress since its inception. In 2009 - only 30 states have ratified the ERA into their legislatures. (*to BETH)* Wait...seriously?!?

BETH. Seriously.

SARAH. So you're telling me that there are 20 states that have wireless internet, high definition cable television and all sorts of millennial luxuries...but they haven't ratified the Equal Rights Amendment? That's messed up.

BETH. That's the point of the lecture.

SARAH. What? To bum me out?

BETH. No. (*to audience)* It's no secret that over the past several years, the word 'feminist' has become a dirty word to some people. They equate it with hating men or being an anarchist, neither of which is true. Being a feminist means believing in the equality between women and men.

SARAH. Being a feminist means believing that a woman has a right to work and a man has a right to stay home with the kids.

BETH. We have come a long...

SARAH. ...long way.

BETH. We have earned the right to vote.

SARAH. We have earned the right to own property.

BETH. We have opened the door to discussing reproductive health.

SARAH. We have opened the door for single mothers and single fathers.

BETH. We have fought for stricter punishment for violent crimes.

SARAH. We have fought to marry whomever we love.

BETH. We are still fighting to marry whomever we love.

SARAH. We are still fighting for equal pay for equal work.

BETH. We are still fighting for cures and preventative medicine.

SARAH. We are still fighting for fair representations in the media.

BETH. We are still fighting. That's the point of this lecture. No matter how much the women who have walked the earth before us have fought - we are still fighting.

BOTH. So fight.

SARAH. Fight hard.

BETH. Fight loud.

SARAH. Fight for the girls who are too young to fight for themselves.

BETH. Fight for the women who are unable to fight for themselves.

SARAH. Join non-profit organizations.

BETH. Donate your money or your time. Your assignment for this class is to simply...

BOTH. Do something. Anything.

BETH. Class is dismissed.

...Throwing Your Voice

by Julia Neva

PERFORMANCE NOTE: No ventriloquism experience is needed when performing this piece. If you have a performer who is capable of throwing her voice, then it may be possible to showcase this talent in the early stages of EMILY playing with DUMMY. DUMMY will always speak for herself. DUMMY is an extension of EMILY, so she will reflect EMILY'S mood early on, then eventually develop her own personality to argue back with her.

EMILY. (*enters somewhat awkwardly, loaded down with backpack, books and purse, worn out)* Ugh. It's days like this that make me want to be home-schooled. (*Calls out)* Mom? MOM! Mom, are you home? (*listens, then with sarcasm)* Mom, can I have tons of friends over for a loud crazy keg party? If so - then don't answer. (*silence)* Awesome, I can have a loud crazy keg party. Now all I need are tons of friends. Or even just a couple of friends. (*goes to open fridge and finds a note)* Ah, the note from Mom.

MOM. *(voiceover as note)* "Hey sugar-booger!"

EMILY. I hate when she calls me that.

MOM. "Sorry I couldn't be here to see you home from school."

EMILY. Pfft. You never are.

MOM. "I hope you're okay with holding down the house 'til I get back."

EMILY. What? Is it gonna float away? I'm sixteen. I think I can handle it.

MOM. "Martin and I have an appointment at the baby doctor this afternoon for my check-up, then we need to run some errands so we can get work done on the nursery so we probably won't be home until later."

EMILY. (*making faces while MOM reads note, gets snack out of fridge)*

MOM. I know you're still trying to get to know Martin."

EMILY. What's there to get to know about Count Dork-ula?

MOM. "He's not fond of the nickname Count Dork-ula, after all, accounting is an important profession. I know the past several months have been hard on you - with Dad leaving, Martin coming into our lives and now a new baby on the way. Since he knows how much you love performing, Martin bought you a present! It's on the coffee

table in the living room. We'll be home at 8. Love you! Mom."

EMILY. A present? (*excited)* Oh, man! (*exiting the kitchen and goes toward the living room)* If Martin actually got me the dance lessons I've been want-(*enters living room, other partner steps out to reveal DUMMY slumped over with a big wooden smile and empty eyes staring straight at EMILY.)* A ventriloquist's dummy?!? WHAT?!? You have GOT to be kidding me! (*DUMMY will maintain a stiff pose and will stare at EMILY in the scene until she picks up DUMMY to make it talk. To DUMMY)* What are you staring at? Creeper. (*tries to close DUMMY'S eyes, but the lids pop back open and the big grin remains)* Seriously? What person in their right mind gives a sixteen-year-old girl a ventriloquist's dummy? (*goes to pick up the DUMMY, who gets 'in position' on EMILY's lap. EMILY starts working the DUMMY)* Ha ha. Let's see, how does this work? (*At first, EMILY is just goofing around with the DUMMY, the DUMMY's movements should mirror EMILY working/handling it)*

DUMMY. (*babbling, acting silly)* Blah blah blah. Doopity doopity weee-ooooo. Duh, look at me, I'm a big dumb stupid dummy.

EMILY. Heh heh, or better yet.

DUMMY. Martin is a big old DORK-ula if he thinks this dummy is a good idea. Hee-yuk, hee-yuk.

EMILY. Wait a sec - there's a tag on it. It says its name is Sassy Sally.

DUMMY. (*Excitedly overlapping EMILY)* Sassy Sally!

EMILY. Ugh. Gag me.

DUMMY. Don't tempt me, princess.

EMILY. Heh. What are you going to do, ya' stinkin' lump of wood?

DUMMY. I'll smack you so hard your grandkids will be born with splinters.

EMILY. How are you going to do that when I'm the one working you?

DUMMY. Yeah. Let's talk about that, shall we?

EMILY. About what?

DUMMY. Your hands.

EMILY. What about them?

DUMMY. They're horrible. Rough. Cold. It feels like an alligator who's been ice fishing. Seriously. Call me when you get some lotion and a pair of gloves.

EMILY. Wow. For a pile of rejected beaver feed, you sure have an attitude problem.

DUMMY. It's not *my* attitude that needs adjusting, sister.

EMILY. Well it's not *my* fault!

DUMMY. Of course not.

EMILY. Thanks.

DUMMY. That was sarcasm, kiddo. Sheesh…and they call *me* a dummy.

EMILY. You better watch it…(*stops, then drops DUMMY - who goes limp)* What is wrong with me? I'm having a conversation with myself. No. Worse. I'm having a conversation with a doll. I am losing my mind. Thankfully, no one is here to watch my decline into Dork-ula territory. (*picks up DUMMY, readjusts*) Listen, dummy.

DUMMY. Sally.

EMILY. Huh?

DUMMY. My name is Sally. Unless you want me to start referring to you as Fleshie, then I suggest we get on a first-name basis pronto.

EMILY. Okay, Sally.

DUMMY. Thanks, Emily.

EMILY. So, Sally…what makes you so Sassy anyway?

DUMMY. *(matter of fact)* Well, ever since my boyfriend Pinnocchio left me for a Nutcracker… (*sarcastic)* whaddya mean 'what makes me so sassy?'

EMILY. You have a lot of anger for a toy.

DUMMY. I'm not the one with all the pent up anger.

EMILY. What are you talking about? You've been freaking out on me since the second I picked you up.

DUMMY. Isn't it obvious?

EMILY. Isn't what obvious?

DUMMY. Do I need to buy you a copy of "Dummies for Dummies"?

EMILY. You're two seconds away from being firewood for a bunch of kids singing "Koom-bye-yah" if you don't get to your point.

DUMMY. (*sighs*) Emily…Emily…Emily…

EMILY. WHAT?

DUMMY. Do you want to know a little secret?

EMILY. (*reluctant)* Maybe.

DUMMY. Here, lean closer. (*EMILY leans a little bit)* A little closer. (*EMILY leans a bit more)* Closer. (*EMILY leans a bit more)* What? I don't have any teeth, I'm not going to bite you. Just come a little closer. (*EMILY leans, her head is right by DUMMY, who whispers)* Do you

want to know the secret, Emily?

EMILY. (*whispers)* Yes.

DUMMY. *(whispers)* Do you really?

EMILY. (*whispers)* Yes. Really.

DUMMY. *(whispers)* Okay. I'll tell you. (*inhales, takes an excessively long pause to build suspense, then shouts at the top of her lungs)* YOU'RE THE ONE WITH THE ANGER PROBLEM, FREAK-A-ZOID!!! I'M JUST A WOODEN DUMMY!

EMILY. (*in pain, angry*) THIS IS SO STUPID! UGH!!! (*throws down DUMMY - who goes limp)* I don't have some stupid freaking anger problem! Do you hear me? You stupid doll. (*kicks DUMMY. DUMMY is silent)* Well? Don't you have something funny to say? Some sassy remark, Sassy Sally? It's no wonder I'm going crazy…this is the first real conversation I've had in months. (*stares at DUMMY)* I mean, this is silly, right? Me talking to a dummy? (*stares at DUMMY)* You think I'm mental, don't you? (*stares at DUMMY)* Oh good grief…(*picks up DUMMY)*

DUMMY. *(overdramatic gasp)* Ahhh…that's better. I hate being thrown on the floor like that.

EMILY. I'm sorry.

DUMMY. Well you should be!

EMILY. I said I'm sorry. I was upset.

DUMMY. Well…DUH. I could tell you were upset. Heck - I'm pretty sure there's life on other planets that could tell you were upset.

EMILY. Well, my mom can't tell that I'm upset.

DUMMY. (*beat, softer)* She's doing the best she can, you know.

EMILY. The best at what? Can't she tell how much this whole thing bothers me?

DUMMY. I don't think you're being fair.

EMILY. (*laughs, shocked and offended)* Ha ha ha!! I'M not being fair? ME? The one who is unfair? How is any of this my fault?

DUMMY. Emily, calm down.

EMILY. NO! None of this is my fault! I didn't ask for any of this. I didn't ask for my dad to just up and move to another city. I didn't ask for my mom to start dating the most boring man on the face of the planet. And I sure didn't ask for my mom to get pregnant with what will probably be more the most boring half-sibling on the planet leaving

me stuck with some stupid stinking step-father that I never wanted. I never wanted any of this.

DUMMY. Well neither did your mom.

EMILY. Oh puh-lease. She's tickled pink with her new boyfriend and her new baby. She's happy and doesn't give two flips about me anymore.

DUMMY. For crying out loud, Fleshie, your mom didn't want any of this and she certainly isn't as hunkie-dorie as you make her out to be. But she's trying to be happy for you.

EMILY. What are you talking about?

DUMMY. Dad was a creep.

EMILY. Shut up.

DUMMY. Dad was a creep and you know it, Emily. He was never around and when he was, he was either yelling at mom or ignoring her.

EMILY. That's not true.

DUMMY. He was nice to you but was horrible to her.

EMILY. You're lying!

DUMMY. I can't, Emily. You're trying to lie to yourself. But you can't. (*beat*) Dad was a jerk to everyone but you, and you know that. (*silence)* You worried that if you said something to him it would make him leave. But then he left anyway.

EMILY. He didn't leave a note or anything. (*beat)* I just….I miss him.

DUMMY. That's what's making you so angry.

EMILY. It's been months and he hasn't called. We used to talk every night.

DUMMY. And it hurts that he can't even find a second to call…

EMILY. …or send an e-mail.

DUMMY. Mom is trying her best.

EMILY. I guess.

DUMMY. No, Emily. She is. She is trying so hard to piece together a normal life for the two of you. She struggles to smile everyday to let you know that everything will be okay, but you just continue to skulk around the house feeling sorry for yourself. Have you ever asked your mom how she feels? You may have lost a dad - but she lost her husband too. That's gotta be hard on her.

EMILY. Huh. I never thought of it that way.

DUMMY. And yes - Martin is a huge, gaping…

EMILY. …monumental…

DUMMY. Count Dorkula…but he's really nice…to *both* of you. He makes your mom happy. And he's trying to make you happy, too, if you'd just give him the chance.

EMILY. You're right.

DUMMY. Of course I'm right. I was carved from 'The Giving Tree'. I give out advice like candy on Halloween.

EMILY. I guess I owe mom and Count Dork…(*DUMMY coughs and gives her a look)* Sorry…mom and Martin an apology. I just can't get over how mad at dad I am.

DUMMY. That's fine, Emily. You have a right to be angry at him. He's proven to be worth about as much a bag of squirrel turds lately.

EMILY. Ew.

DUMMY. I know. Be angry at him. He deserves it. But your mom, Martin and the friends you had before you took a one-way train to Angsty-town - they're not the ones to be angry at.

EMILY. I know.

DUMMY. Go ahead. Make amends. You'll be happier when you do.

EMILY. Thanks, Sally. (*jokingly)* You took the words right out of my mouth!

DUMMY. (*beat, unamused)* Lame.

EMILY. Harsh, much?

DUMMY. Leave the jokes to me kid. (*hears cell phone)* I think that's your cell phone ringing. It's probably mom.

EMILY. Listen, don't tell anyone about our heart-to-heart, okay?

DUMMY. Believe me, I couldn't if I tried.

EMILY. Thanks. (*puts DUMMY down, it goes limp, she crosses to pick up her phone*) Hello, mom? (*beat)* Yeah. Hey. No, everything is fine. (*beat)* Yes, I found it in the living room. Listen, mom…I need to tell you something. (*beat)* No, I'm not on 'the drugs'. I swear. (*beat)* Mom, I just wanted to say, I'm sorry for being so crabby lately. I really love you and I feel bad for not asking you how you've been doing since dad left. (*beat)* Aw, mom stop it, you're gonna make me cry now. I just wanted to tell you and Martin I'm sorry. (*beat)* Okay. I'll see you when you get home. (*beat)* Love you, too. Bye.

Swerve

by Amanda Thompson

(*EMMA enters while CALLIE is rummaging through her closet, searching for something to wear.)*

EMMA. (*very cautious)* Hey.

CALLIE. (*distracted)* Oh. Hey.

EMMA. Your mom told me you would be up here.

CALLIE. And coincidence of all coincidences…here I am.

EMMA. I see that.

CALLIE. Good old mom, always knowing where in the house I am. I should tip her more often.

EMMA. *(weirded out)* Uh, okay.

CALLIE. So what are you up to, Emma? I feel like haven't seen you in, like, forever.

EMMA. I'm fine. Thanks. (*pause)* The bigger question is, how are *you* doing, Callie?

CALLIE. Ugh. Horrible.

EMMA. Really?

CALLIE. Yeah. I totally flaked out on my paper on The Sound and the Fury for AP English and I doubt Mrs. Wright it going to extend the deadline for me and…

EMMA. I don't think Mrs. Wright is going to care about the paper, Callie.

CALLIE. …and I am, like, super behind on my Chem lab experiments plus…

EMMA. Callie.

CALLIE. I haven't been to soccer practice, and I can feel my muscles getting…

EMMA. Callie, I don't think you need to worry about all that.

CALLIE. Huh?

EMMA. Listen, I don't know how to tell you this…

CALLIE. Tell me what? Oh, no. I don't have a booger…

EMMA. Your mom wanted me to come up and talk to you.

CALLIE. Pfft. That was lazy of her. There goes her tip.

EMMA. She's worried about you. A lot of people are.

CALLIE. Oh. Well, tell her…them…thanks but I'm cool. I can get the paper finished over the weekend and just beg Mrs. Wright…

EMMA. Stop it, Callie.

CALLIE. Stop what, Emma?

EMMA. Stop acting like you don't know what I'm talking about. (*silence*) So what, no funny one-liners for me? (*silence*) It's been a week and you haven't said a word to anyone other than the police and the hospital staff. Now you're acting like everything is hunkie-dorie and it's freaking everybody out. (*silence, then quietly)* You have to talk

about it. The accident. Eric. You can't keep acting like nothing happened.

CALLIE. Is that it? Is that the message my mom tied to your leg like a little pigeon to bring up here to me?

EMMA. That, and one other thing.

CALLIE. Which is?

EMMA. That I'm not allowed to leave this room until you talk about what happened.

CALLIE. And if I don't?

EMMA. She gave me a toothbrush. I think she means it.

CALLIE. Typical mom. So melodramatic.

EMMA. Callie, I'm not trying to push your buttons or anything.

CALLIE. Really? Because you sure seem more-than-willing to be my parents' little lap dog and come running up here when they don't know what to do with their own daughter.

EMMA. So what happened?

CALLIE. Wow, Barbara Walters, great interviewing skills.

EMMA. What?

CALLIE. You're not going to warm me up with some small talk first? Just want to jump into the heavy stuff right off the bat.

EMMA. We have been. There's been nothing but small talk for the past few minutes. I'm sure you're sufficiently warmed.

CALLIE. Says you.

EMMA. I'm being serious.

CALLIE. So am I.

EMMA. (*sigh*) What is it going to take to get you to start talking about the accident?

CALLIE. Gossip.

EMMA. Huh?

CALLIE. The dirtiest, nastiest gossip you have. Spill.

EMMA. About what? Who?

CALLIE. Anyone. Preferably someone popular, bonus points if they're pretty and vapid.

EMMA. Good word, by the way.

CALLIE. I know. Thank you, SAT prep. Now dish.

EMMA. Um…I dunno…uh…(*thinks)* oh…I think I heard that the boy Trisha Goodwin spent making out with all summer is actually her second cousin.

CALLIE. Ew. Nuh-uh.

EMMA. Yeah. She's mortified.

CALLIE. Understandably. How did she not know?

EMMA. It was on her dad's side of the family and her parents have been divorced since she was two, so she doesn't really know that side of her family that well. Plus - she met him at soccer camp over the summer. She didn't think to ask, "Hey - are we related?" But I mean, second cousin isn't that big of a deal, really.

CALLIE. Truly a morality play for our generation. What else?

EMMA. Amber returned to school after having "mono." Somehow a side effect of having "mono" made her nose a different shape, if you catch my drift.

CALLIE. Scandal.

EMMA. Yeah.

CALLIE. Well, good for her. It was about time she got that huge beak of hers fixed. It was beginning to depress me.

EMMA. Are you depressed right now?

CALLIE. UGH. You just won't stop will you?

EMMA. Won't stop? We haven't even started to talk about anything real.

CALLIE. Puh-leez. You had 'tragic' written all over your face the minute you walked into my room. I could smell it from down the hall.

EMMA. No, I didn't.

CALLIE. Yes you did! You walked into my room all sad and somber-like, your head hung down and making that dopey face you make when you don't want anyone around you to get upset.

EMMA. Rude, much?

CALLIE. It's true. You've been treating me like everyone else lately.

EMMA. Really? And how's that?

CALLIE. Like I'm going to fall apart at any minute.

EMMA. Are you? You haven't given anyone any clue that you're not on the verge of a nervous break-down.

CALLIE. Other than the fact that I haven't? I haven't wailed, or screamed, or ripped the hair from my head or acted like a mental case at all. I've kept it together…

EMMA. No, you've been acting like some fake, plasticy robot and people are worried. People are beginning to talk.

CALLIE. Talk about what? About how I'm not putting on a show for them?

EMMA. People don't want a show, they want to know that you're allowing yourself to feel things, to not act like everything is okay when you….when the…um.

CALLIE. Say it.

EMMA. I don't know what you're talking about.

CALLIE. "To not act like everything is okay when I…" what? What did I do?

EMMA. That's not what I meant. It's not something you did.

CALLIE. Say it. Say, "People want you to not act like everything is okay when you walked away from the accident and Eric didn't."

EMMA. Callie…

CALLIE. Nope. You opened the door, now you have to walk through it.

EMMA. He was your boyfriend…

CALLIE. So.

EMMA. …of three years.

CALLIE. Are you just going to list off facts about his life? He was an Aries.

EMMA. You have to talk to someone.

CALLIE. Talk to someone about what?

EMMA. About the love of your life getting killed in a car accident that you walked away from with barely any injuries! That! That is what people want you to talk about! You don't walk away from something like that without feeling anything. No normal person can survive that and then turn around and start worrying about some Faulkner essay they need to write.

CALLIE. This is stupid. Just get out.

EMMA. No.

CALLIE. I'm serious, Emma. Get out of my room.

EMMA. I'm not leaving, Callie.

CALLIE. I don't want to talk about this!

EMMA. WHY?!? Why are you so afraid to talk about this? You're the most talkative person that I know. You'll gab for an hour over the phone about what you ate during the day. You could write a book about your feelings about any one of our teachers. You're dying to know the "dirtiest dirt" on all of our mutual friends, but the first really important thing you have to talk about - and you just clam up. Why? I don't get it. What are you scared of?

CALLIE. That's not it.

EMMA. Tell me!

CALLIE. I FEEL GUILTY, OKAY?!

EMMA. You shouldn't feel guilty because you lived, Callie. Eric would have wanted you to go on and do all these wonderful...

CALLIE. I don't feel guilty about living. I'm glad I lived.

EMMA. (*confused)* Then what do you feel guilty about?

CALLIE. I don't know if the car wreck was an accident.

EMMA. (*silence)* What do you mean?

CALLIE. (*heavy sigh)* That night, in the car, Eric and I were having a...heated discussion, and I dunno. (*silence)* I was trying to call it off with Eric.

EMMA. (*stunned)* Wait...what? You two were perfect together...you were always together, laughing...you were the couple everyone was jealous of...you were...

CALLIE. Seeing someone else.

EMMA. Eric?

CALLIE. Me.

EMMA. Who?

CALLIE. Doesn't matter.

EMMA. WHO?

CALLIE. A guy from the restaurant I work at. It wasn't anything serious, but I was trying to keep it hush-hush 'til I could break up with Eric.

EMMA. What did he say?

CALLIE. He cried, okay. Loud. Noisy. Messy crying. I told him that it was over, I was seeing someone else and he started to cry. Emma, I didn't know what else to do. There were so many other times when I wanted to break things off with Eric but the timing never seemed

right.

EMMA. Why that night?

CALLIE. It was just...I dunno...

EMMA. No, you do know. Why?

CALLIE. Dinner. It was the stupidest little thing. I went to the ladies' room right after we were seated at our table. The waitress came to take the order for our drinks and he ordered me an iced tea. I got back, sat down and stared at the glass. I never drink ice tea. Never. I hate the way it tastes. But I just stared at that glass and thought, "He doesn't know what I like to drink. What else does he not know about?" I couldn't do it anymore. He didn't really know me. I'm starting to think that I didn't even really know me. The one thing I did know was that I was miserable and had been for a very long time. So I told him. I told him everything.

EMMA. But you said you weren't sure if it was an accident...are you saying that Eric tried to kill you?

CALLIE. Get real, Emma. This isn't some freaky Hollywood movie. It's not like Eric flipped out and was all, "If I can't have you, then no one can have you." It wasn't like that. Nobody can fathom how one of the most level-headed guys in the world could lose control. Eric was sobbing and incoherent - but he could have pulled over. He knew better. He doesn't even drive and talk on the phone, but in that moment - in that car - he chose to keep driving. I kept begging him to pull over so we could talk about it but he refused. All he could do was keep saying, "How could you do this, Callie? I loved you, Callie. You were everything to me...." then boom. Black out. I wake up to smoke and shattered glass.

EMMA. Callie, I'm so sorry.

CALLIE. He was still alive.

EMMA. But - the cops said he died on impact.

CALLIE. I lied. He didn't. For a few minutes, we were both awake in the wrecked car.

EMMA. (*stunned)* What...what...did you say anything?

CALLIE. He asked me if I was hurt. I said yes. He said he was sorry he hurt me. He said that no matter what I did to him, it would never to be bad enough for him to want to hurt me. I told him I was sorry I hurt him. Then he just... (*beat)* So, no, Emma. I haven't wanted to talk to my parents or friends. I haven't wanted to talk to the counselors or the doctors. I can't keep reliving that accident. I can't keep wondering if my selfishness killed the guy I spent nearly three years of my life with. I can't spend the rest of my life feeling guilty. People break up all the time! People cheat all the time. But those people don't have a dead ex-boyfriend on their conscience. I've been acting like everything is okay because that's about as close to okay as I'll get for the rest of my life. And I don't need the rest of the world judging me because of it. (*both pause and hear Callie's mom*

calling up to the girls)

EMMA. (*offstage shout to Callie's mom)* Everything is fine, Mrs. Epperson! (*to Callie)* Callie, you have to talk to your parents.

CALLIE. (*tearful*) I can't.

EMMA. You have to. You have to talk to someone else.

CALLIE. Everyone will hate me.

EMMA. It's not your fault, Callie.

CALLIE. Yes, it is.

EMMA. No, Callie. You weren't driving the car. There's no way you could control Eric. No one will blame you. Or Eric. It was an accident.

CALLIE. I cheated on him.

EMMA. That was between you and Eric. You can't change that now. But you cannot keep this bottled up. (*picks her up)* Here. We're going to wash your face, walk downstairs and tell your mom everything. Everything is going to be okay.

CALLIE. I can't thank you enough, Emma.

EMMA. That's what friends do. Besides, you can just add to my tip jar.

CALLIE. (*weakly chuckles)* Done.

Thirty-Six Minutes

by Jesse Gall

(*A restaurant. Deb waits anxiously, twitching.*)

DEB. Ugh. This is just so…typical.

KATE. (*stumbling in*) Hi!

DEB. Well, there you are.

KATE. Oh for crying out loud, you can't even say hello?

DEB. Well, you're thirty-six minutes late.

KATE. Thirty-six min—You're so strange.

DEB. Why is that strange? You're thirty-six—

KATE. I know! But most people just say half an hour, not…Thirty. Six. Minutes.

DEB. Well, but you were thirty- six minutes late not half an—

KATE. Okay! Alright! I get it!

DEB. There's no need not to be precise.

KATE. (*sighs*) Deb…

DEB. Yeah, sorry. I know.

KATE. How is she?

DEB. Oh so you're interested now—

KATE. Deb!

DEB. Sorry, I know. Well, it's started again.

INTRO

KATE. So Mom's finally gone too crazy, huh? How bad is she this time?

DEB. She's not living at home anymore. She's at a hospital. We have to clear out some of her stuff so that we can sell the house.

KATE. And since when did we decide to sell the house?

DEB. Well, let's not pretend that you care. We both know you need the money, so save the fraudulent attempt at nostalgia or sadness.

KATE. (*silence*) Wow.

DEB. I know. I'm sorry.

KATE. You keep saying that…"I know, I'm sorry. Sorry, I know." I wish you would stop. Mom said that all the time. We used to hate that phrase.

DEB. Well, you live with someone long enough and it's hard not pick up a few behaviors.

KATE. You didn't live with her that long.

DEB. Five years, Eleven months, sixteen days.

KATE. Six years?

DEB. No, Five years, Eleven—

KATE. Okay! It's been six years?

DEB. Welcome back, sister. Hope your vacation from us was worth it. Get

your stuff. I'm not hungry. We have to get working on the house; I'd like to finish this as soon as possible. You'll be sleeping in Mom's room.

KATE. Deb, c'mon. I'd rather sleep on a couch.

DEB. The couches have been cleared out. You'll just have to sleep in Mom's room. I'm sure you'll be fine. You probably don't even remember it.

KATE. I seriously doubt that.

(*At the house the next morning. In the living room, boxes all over the floor.*)

KATE. Ugh.

DEB. Well, good morning. It's about time. It's almost 9:30. I thought for a second you would sleep 'til noon.

KATE. I would have if it weren't for the monster truck rally occurring in our living room.

DEB. Oh, was I loud? So sorry.

KATE. Yeah, sure. Coffee?

DEB. Kitchen.

KATE. Mmm. (*from kitchen*) So what are all those license plates in Mom's room?

DEB. Mom's old room. It's not her room anymore.

KATE. (*still from kitchen*) What?

DEB. Nothing. The license plates…She started collecting those when you left.

KATE. (*back to living room, sipping coffee*) What? That doesn't make any sense.

DEB. Well, she would spend days tracking down old antique license plates whenever we got a new postcard from you. She said it made her feel more familiar with the places you were going. She felt closer to you.

KATE. Wow.

DEB. She missed you…for some reason. So, let's get to work then. I've divided the room into four quadrants of boxes that need to be sorted through based on chronology. We have "Married," "After He Left," "Mentally Ill" and "After She Left."

KATE. Deb…

DEB. Though I know it's a little flawed because I guess she's been mentally ill through all of the other phases too, but—

KATE. Deb!

DEB. Hmm? What are you yelling about?

KATE. This is seriously messed up, Deb. Most people just categorize with, like, "Family Room" and "Christmas Stuff."

DEB. Well, we never really had a family or a Christmas, so I thought my labels were more appropriate.

KATE. I can't do this.

DEB. I don't care. We're doing this. Now.

KATE. No. I…I gotta go. (*leaving*)

DEB. (*screaming*) Kate! Kate! You can't just keep leaving. I can't do this alone! (*Frazzled, Gathers herself. Realizes she's alone.*) Well, here I am again. Wonderful. Just wonderful.

(*At living room. Kate returns home cautiously. Deb is staring at a box of clothes.*)

KATE. Deb…(*Deb says nothing*)…Deb…(*still nothing*)…Deb, you have to talk to me eventually.

DEB. Oh, so now you want to talk? Six years and you want to talk? Well, frankly, I'm not at your beck and call so, no. I don't think I do have to talk to you eventually.

KATE. You're my sister, Deb.

DEB. Since when?

(*Silence. Kate doesn't know what to say.*)

DEB. You left. You don't have any rights here. You know, she was actually getting better before you left. She was, I know it. The tantrums were becoming less frequent, she was sleeping, hardly any night terrors, and she hadn't had an incident in three months.

KATE. You mean a suicide attempt. There's no need not to be precise, right?

DEB. Yes. A suicide attempt. It had been three months. She was getting better. And then you left. You just had to leave.

KATE. It was not getting better! Things were worse than ever. Don't try to revise history when it's written on my body in scars.

DEB. But she was getting better…

KATE. No she wasn't!

DEB. (*exploding*) Fine! She wasn't getting better! It doesn't matter anyway! Because when you left, it got worse! She stayed up for days until she was delusional with sleep deprivation, babbling nonsense, describing the ways that she would kill herself, organizing and reorganizing the kitchen four times a day, throwing screaming rages that left claw marks all over my arms. She thought I would leave her. So she hated me. And I can't blame her for thinking that. She was just expecting me to do what Dad and you did. She was awful. And you got to parade around the country sending in little postcards that made her happier than I ever could. You, the daughter who abandoned her, she loved, but me, the caretaker, the only one who stood by her side, she hated. She hated me!

KATE. Wow.

DEB. Ugh! I did NOT want to talk right now.

KATE. Look, she didn't hate you, Deb. She hated me. She sent me letters to

wherever I would send a postcard from, detailing every way I was torturing my mother and sister. How I was selfish. How I wasn't worth anything. She hated me.

DEB. She sent you letters?

KATE. Yup.

DEB. Why would she that she hated you when she told me the opposite?

KATE. Because she's sick, Deb. She's really sick. You can't be responsible for the things she said. Her mind isn't right, you can't believe anything she says. Our mom is mentally ill, Kate.

DEB. But…

KATE. That's why I left, Deb. She was doing too much damage, and I didn't want to believe her anymore.

DEB. Well…

KATE. I'm sorry, Deb. I'm really sorry.

DEB. Well, I suppose you are, aren't you?

KATE. Yeah. (*silence*) Okay then, so I guess I'll start with "Mentally Ill" and "After She Left" if you'll take "Marriage" and "After He Left."

DEB. Uh…well. Okay. Yes. That's fine. Maybe we can be done with this today.

KATE. Yeah, it's time to finish this. And if we finish, like, thirty-six minutes early, maybe we can go out and get something to eat. Catch up.

DEB. (*smiling slightly*) Maybe. If I can spare thirty-six minutes.

The New Girl

by Julia Neva

SCENE 1

KIMMY. (*On her cell phone*) Listen, Frank – as far as agents go, you've been doing a pretty lousy job at booking me jobs. … Uh huh. …Yeah, right. It's been nearly two years since the show ended, and I'm really tired of waiting around for something new to pop up.…What do you mean no one wants to work with me because of my "attitude problem"? I don't have an "attitude problem." I have a "I don't like having to tell people three times older than me how to do their job" problem. Besides, it's not my fault that make-up artist quit.…It is? Oh, well. She can go back to putting lip gloss on rabbits for all I care. Pay attention, Frank, because I'm not going to tell you this twice: Find me an audition and get me out of this public school before I throw up. Or turn thirteen. Chop. Chop. (*hangs up her phone*).

MRS. HALTRON. Kimberly?

KIMMY. It's Kimmy. What?

MRS. HALTRON. We were in the middle of diagramming sentences.

KIMMY. Yeah. So?

MRS. HALTRON. So, it was a bit rude to talk on your cell phone while I'm trying to teach.

KIMMY. Uh.…what's your point?

MRS. HALTRON. Students aren't allowed to have cell phones at school, much less use them in class.

KIMMY. Look, Mrs. Haltron. I'll make a deal with you. You let me conduct my really important business affairs when I need to – and I'll dip into my vast wealth to buy you an outfit that's a little less ugly. (*under her breath*) If they make them in your size, that is.

MRS. HALTRON. That's it. Go to the principal's office, young lady.

KIMMY. Seriously?

MRS. HALTRON. Seriously.

KIMMY. I thought they just did that in movies.

MRS. HALTRON. No, we do it here in Fullerton as well.

KIMMY. Okay. (*looks through classroom and points to people*) You. You. You. Come with me.

MRS. HALTRON. What in the world are you doing?

KIMMY. I don't go anywhere without my entourage.

MRS. HALTRON. (*Rubbing her head and writing a note*) Kimmy…just…go to the principal's office.

KIMMY. Fine. Later, losers.

SCENE 2

SARAH. (*Holding an ice pack to her head, is waiting outside the principal's office. She watches Kimmy walk back and forth a few times.*) Can I help you?

KIMMY. (*Defiant*) No.

SARAH. Okay. (*She watches Kimmy strut around aimlessly a bit longer.*) Are you lost?

KIMMY. Does it look like I'm lost?

SARAH. Kinda. Sorta. Yeah.

KIMMY. Well…I'm not. I'm researching a role.

SARAH. Researching a role?

KIMMY. Yeah. Don't you know who I am?

SARAH. Not really.

KIMMY. UGH. I'm Kimmy Kilgore. Ring a bell?

SARAH. Nope. Sorry.

KIMMY. I'm an actress….

SARAH. (*Searching*) Uh…

KIMMY. ….on television…

SARAH. (*Searching*) Mmmm…

KIMMY. Oh, for crying out loud! I starred as the Bionic Baby for five sea sons! I have an honorary Young Actors Guild Award for the role! I appeared in the Dreamy Boyz music video for the song "She's Got the Hair". See? (*flips hair*) I've got the hair!

SARAH. (*Fake recognition*) Oh! Yeah. No. Sorry. I don't watch TV.

KIMMY. You're kidding, right?

SARAH. Sadly, no. My parents think television rots the brain and destroys independent thinking.

KIMMY. What a horrible thing to say!

SARAH. Yeah. Needless to say – it doesn't make being the new kid any easier when you can't talk about what was on TV the night before.

KIMMY. Oh. You're new at this school too?

SARAH. Yep. I was home schooled up 'til now.

KIMMY. Oh! Like the kids from "Mystery Island Adventure"?

SARAH. Huh?

KIMMY. It was a show about a family that gets shipwrecked so the mom teaches them to count using coconuts.

SARAH. Yeah. That's *exactly* what home schooling is like. (*looks at Kimmy*) What are you writing down?

KIMMY. Character study notes. I may have to play a home school girl one day in a film and you're providing me with some wonderful authenticity.

SARAH. Whatever you say. (*They stand in silence, after a while, she speaks in a high pitched fake voice.*) Gee, girl-with-an-ice-pack-on-your-head, what's your name?

KIMMY. I don't have an icepack. What are you talking about?

SARAH. (*Sighs*) My name is Sarah, by the way.

KIMMY. By-the-way? Is that French?

SARAH. For your sake, we'll say it is.

KIMMY. So, why do you have an icepack on your head…outside the principal's office?

SARAH. Thank you for asking. Well, I got into a scuffle with a couple of older girls. I had asked a random guy in the hall for directions when this girl got up in my face and was like, "Were you talking to my boyfriend? I know you weren't talking to my boyfriend!" then slammed my head into the locker. At that point, people began chanting "Fight! Fight! Fight!", and a teacher pulled us apart and sent both of us here.

KIMMY. Did you say anything to the girl?

SARAH. What do you mean?

KIMMY. I mean – did you stand up for yourself? Tell she was a psychopath and you didn't care about her nasty old boyfriend?

SARAH. No…I'm not really confrontational.

KIMMY. That's dumb.

SARAH. Excuse me?

KIMMY. You heard me. I said that's dumb. Why in the world would you let someone push you around like that? And not put her in her place? This one time on the set of Bionic Baby, there was a huge line at the craft services table. I was positively famished so I went to the front to get something to eat really quickly when some extra got all uppity about me cutting in line and how I should have to wait for my turn like everyone else. So I whipped around and said, "When someone decides that you have a fraction of the talent I have to merit you a speaking role – then we'll talk." Needless to say – I didn't have a problem with that extra after that. But you – you just let some crazy person smash your head in a locker and you didn't even have the backbone to tell her to leave you alone? Maybe you should have gotten some sense knocked into you.

SARAH. (*Shocked*) I can't believe you would say that.

KIMMY. It's true! I don't even let adults talk to me like that. Nobody is going to respect you if you don't demand it.

SARAH. Now that's what I call dumb.

KIMMY. Oh yeah? What do *you* know? You're just some naïve little home schooled girl who doesn't know what it's like in the real world. That's probably why you weren't allowed out of the house until now.

SARAH. That is so not true! I know for a fact that you can't bully people into respecting you.

KIMMY. What?

SARAH. Come on. I may be new at school but I wasn't born yesterday! I may not have known your name or how you were some big fancy television show but I know who you are.

KIMMY. Hmph. And who's that?

SARAH. You're the girl that walks around here thinking she's above the rest of us. You say nasty, horrible outright cruel things to complete strangers. I don't know if you say things because you think its funny or true or maybe because you think anybody cares enough to listen – but they don't. When you walk down the hall – people don't move out of the way because they respect you – it's because they don't want to get any closer to such a hateful person than they have to. So why don't you take some of that "vast wealth" you have and go unload your anger out on a therapist and leave the rest of us alone.

(*Kimmy stands there – stung and stunned. Tears well up before she looks up to see the Principal standing there.*)

KIMMY. Yes, Principal Johnson. I have a minute to talk to you about the incident in Mrs. Haltron's room. I wasn't talking to anyone important. (*exits*)

SARAH. Kimmy?

SCENE 3

(*Sarah is still standing outside the principal's office, though her ice pack has melted. She looks a bit distraught, but perks up when Kimmy exits. Kimmy proceeds to stand outside the door and rummage through her purse looking for her cell phone.*)

SARAH. Wow. You were in there for a while…huh? (*no answer*) Did he really rip into you? (*no answer*) I didn't hear any yelling so I guess that wasn't the case. I bet you put on a good show and got out of any trouble. Right? (*no answer*) Come on, Kimmy. You're not just going to ignore me…are you?

KIMMY. (*On the phone*) Hello, Frank? Yes, I need for you to arrange for a car to come pick me up. I'll clear out all of my belongings and will be ready to leave in 30 minutes. (*hangs up*)

SARAH. Leave? Why are you leaving? It's not even lunch yet?

KIMMY. (*Fake chipper*) Well you and your little public school friends should be happy to know that I won't be returning to your school. Ever.

SARAH. What? Why?

KIMMY. (*Still lying, trying to cover up*) While I was in the principal's office telling him what an ugly, dirty and disorganized prison he has the nerve to call a school I thought this was, I got a call from my agent. The networks want me to star in a brand new television series and I have to go to a meeting this afternoon. They say the show is going to rocket me to superstardom and that even people who don't have televisions will know who I am.

SARAH. Kimmy…

KIMMY. So if you don't mind – I've got to go clean out my locker so I can be ready to go back to the studio – excuse me.

SARAH. (*Blocks her way*) I don't believe you.

KIMMY. Move it, home school.

SARAH. No.

KIMMY. I said, move it or I'll…

SARAH. Or you'll what? Come on, Kimmy. Tell me the truth. What really happened in there?

KIMMY. You want to know what happened?

SARAH. Yes….please…tell me.

KIMMY. FINE! The principal told me that he didn't think this school was a good "fit" for me. That I didn't seem to be able to study alongside the rest of the students and that my attitude was causing too many problems. So he called my parents and said that it would be best for all parties involved if I had a private tutor for the rest of the year. There. You got what you wanted. Now please, just let me go home so I can be by myself.

SARAH. Kimmy…

KIMMY. No! Just leave me alone! I'm tired of everyone always calling me names and picking on me. I'm sorry if I don't know how to be a normal kid, alright? I grew up on television and nobody ever told me the things you said to me. Nobody ever scolded me or punished me because if I got upset then I wouldn't work and it would wreck the show. Now everyone wants me to watch my mouth and get in line and I've never had to do that before so I don't know how to do it now. So, yeah. The big nasty girl got kicked out of school because she doesn't have any friends. You win. Now move it.

SARAH. That's not true. You do have friends.

KIMMY. No, I don't.

SARAH. Yes, you do. I'm a friend.

KIMMY. You yelled at me.

SARAH. Yeah, I did. Friends yell at each other sometimes. They also forgive each other and say they're sorry. And I'm wrong. Kimmy – I shouldn't have said those things to you. I was being just as mean and hateful as I accused you of being.

KIMMY. Well, you were kinda right. I needed someone to tell me I was being a jerk.

SARAH. Yeah, and you were also kinda right. I had already talked to the principal by the time you came up here. I just didn't want to go back to class and risk running across those girls that picked on me. I was scared. But, I needed someone to tell me how to stand up for myself. Just, maybe just not as harshly as you do. Do you forgive me?

KIMMY. Yeah. Do you forgive me?

SARAH. Of course I do.

KIMMY. Good.

SARAH. So, what do you want to do?

KIMMY. If you want, you can come over and watch television on my flat screen after school. Rot that brain of yours.

SARAH. Ha ha. That sounds awesome.

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SpeechGeek
806 Brownstone Way
Bowling Green, KY 42104
thegeek@speechgeek.com

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